PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota Land Cruiser 250 Series

2024–present (US) · J250

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Know which grade you're looking at**
  The 1958 has round lamps, cloth seats, 245/70R18 tires on 18×7 wheels and no stabilizer disconnect. The Land Cruiser grade has rectangular lamps, 265/70R18 tires, and SDM availability. The 2024 First Edition (5,000 built for North America) keeps the round lamps and adds rock rails, a front skid and a roof rack. Premium Package trucks ride on 20-inch wheels with 265/60R20 tires.

- [ ] **Run the VIN for recalls**
  Campaigns so far include an instrument-cluster software update for displays that can go blank (about 82,000 Toyota and Lexus vehicles, announced May 2026), a corrected load-capacity label on certain 2024 trucks accessorized by Gulf States Toyota, a rear-camera software fix, and a 2024–2027 recall (Toyota 26TA23, interim notice 26TB23; NHTSA 26V673000) for a fuel-tube connector that can disconnect and leak. Check NHTSA or the Toyota app.

- [ ] **Listen for squeal in reverse**
  Front-brake squeal when backing up is covered by TSB T-SB-0006-26, which supersedes T-SB-0046-25 and replaces pads and shims after a technician confirms the problem. Owners say you can tell it's been done from the newer anti-rattle springs on the caliper.

- [ ] **Check the hybrid-battery vents**
  The cooling intakes look like speaker grilles in the lower side trim at the rear door opening. Make sure nothing is blocking them. Owners have found cargo and even a plastic bag over them, and some owners got battery cooling-fan maintenance warnings at low mileage; in one case the dealer found nothing and cleared a reminder it thought had been set at the wrong interval.

- [ ] **Test the 12 V battery**
  Owners on LandCruiserForum.com report no-starts after leaving doors or the hatch open for a few minutes at camp. Have the 12 V battery load-tested and ask whether it has been replaced.

- [ ] **Look underneath**
  On used trucks, pull the front skid plate. Owners report stripped skid-plate bolt threads from repeated oil changes. Look for trail damage, and check whether any lift kit came with an alignment.

- [ ] **Ask for diff and transfer-case service records**
  The owner's manual calls for 75W-85 GL-5 in the differentials, and owners report the dealer parts counter doesn't always stock it. Ask what was used.

- [ ] **Do the range math**
  A 17.9-gallon tank at the EPA's 23 mpg combined is about 410 miles in theory, and less with bigger tires, a roof rack or a trailer. If you travel remote, budget for jerry cans or an aftermarket long-range tank.

YEARS TO KNOW

2024–2025	RECALL	Model years covered by the combination-meter and camera recalls

2024–2027	RECALL	All model years included in the fuel-tube leak recall (26V673000) announced October 2026, so check that it's been done

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Fuel tube connection can leak**
  2024–2027 · NHTSA 26V673000
- ☐ **Combination meter may not show warnings**
  2024–2025 · NHTSA 26V341000
- ☐ **Panoramic View Monitor camera freeze**
  2024–2025 · NHTSA 25V744000
- ☐ **Load-capacity modification label (distributor accessories)**
  2024 · NHTSA 24V548000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **1958**
  Round headlights, unpainted plastic body panels, cloth seats and 245/70R18 tires on 18×7 wheels. Toyota lists rear and center locking differentials as standard on the 1958; the Stabilizer Disconnect Mechanism is a Land Cruiser-grade item.
- ☐ **Land Cruiser grade**
  Rectangular headlights, painted panels, heated and ventilated front seats, wider 265/70R18 tires, rear locker and stabilizer disconnect. The Premium Package brings 20-inch wheels.
- ☐ **First Edition**
  2024 only. Limited to 5,000 for North America, it combines the round headlights with a factory roof rack, rock rails and front skid plate. Check the window sticker or build sheet.
- ☐ **Name confusion**
  In the US and much of Europe it's just 'Land Cruiser'. Japan calls it the Land Cruiser 250, and Australia and other markets keep the Prado name. The Lexus GX 550 is the same platform.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/land-cruiser/250-series/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks